

D696

Foundations of Literacy Through Literature

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A third grader who is the oldest of four siblings reads a grade-level passage aloud quickly and accurately. When asked what happened, she cannot retell it or explain several key words. She also loves recess soccer. Using the Simple View of Reading, where is the breakdown?

- A. Both factors equally.
- B. Neither; she will comprehend once she reads faster.
- C. Decoding.
- D. Language comprehension.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A first grader retells a read-aloud in rich detail and explains new words well, but reads short simple words very slowly and with many errors. Which instructional focus fits best?

- A. Wait, since strong listeners always catch up in decoding.
- B. Explicit, systematic phonics and decoding practice.
- C. More vocabulary and comprehension lessons.
- D. More silent independent reading of trade books.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A kindergarten class has learned short a and the consonants m, s, t, p, and n. The teacher, who recently moved from a middle school position, has a beautiful award-winning picture book the class adores. What should the children read on their own this week?

- A. No books until they know all the letter sounds.
- B. The award-winning picture book, since they love it.
- C. A decodable book built mostly on short a and the taught consonants.
- D. A predictable pattern book they can memorize from the pictures.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

During small-group reading in a bright classroom near the library, a first grader reads “horse” as “pony” in a decodable story that shows a picture of a pony. The group meets every morning at 9:15. What should the teacher prompt?

- A. “What would fit in the sentence?”
- B. “Skip it and keep reading.”
- C. “Look at the letters. Let’s sound it out.”
- D. “Good, that makes sense with the picture.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A second-grade teacher is reading a picture book about a sea turtle that includes the words ocean, swim, reluctant, carapace, and fortunate. The book was a gift from a local aquarium. Which two words are the best targets for direct vocabulary teaching?

- A. All five words equally.
- B. reluctant and fortunate
- C. ocean and swim
- D. carapace and ocean

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher labels photosynthesis a Tier 2 word because students will need it on a science test. What tier is it, and why?

- A. Tier 3, because it is specific to one subject and is best taught within that science lesson.
- B. It has no tier, because long words are never taught directly.
- C. Tier 1, because students hear it often.
- D. Tier 2, because it will be tested.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A fourth-grade teacher finds a novel with a Lexile measure right in the grade band. The novel has a glossy cover and a series of sequels. However, it jumps back and forth in time and uses heavy satire. What should the teacher conclude?

- A. The sequels mean students will stay engaged, so it fits.
- B. The text may be more complex than its Lexile shows; weigh the qualitative features and the readers and task.
- C. Lexile is useless and should be ignored.
- D. It is a good fit because the Lexile is in the band.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Two books have the same Lexile. One is a straightforward story; the other needs a lot of background knowledge about the Civil War. Which part of text complexity explains why the second is harder?

- A. Qualitative features (knowledge demands).
- B. Sentence length.
- C. Quantitative measures.
- D. Reader and task only.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A class that meets in a portable building reads a short story in which a tortoise and a hare race, the slow tortoise wins, and the last line says, “Slow and steady wins the race.” The book has watercolor illustrations. Which genre is this?

- A. Legend
- B. Realistic fiction
- C. Myth
- D. Fable

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants a traditional story that explains how something in nature came to be. Which genre should the teacher look for?

- A.** Tall tale, because all traditional stories explain nature.
- B.** Fable
- C.** Myth or pourquoi tale
- D.** Legend

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A teacher auditing a classroom library, which was funded by a grant last year, finds that the only books with Latino characters are about a holiday celebration and immigration hardship. Shelves were recently repainted. What is the best next step?

- A.** Add books by and about Latino people in many roles and everyday situations, checked for authenticity.
- B.** Wait until the next grant cycle.
- C.** Add one more holiday book to increase the count.
- D.** Remove the hardship book, since sad stories should never be shared.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A preschool teacher reads a picture book to four-year-olds while sitting in a rocking chair her grandmother gave her. A child points and says, "Truck!" Which response follows dialogic reading?

- A.** "Good." and keep reading.
- B.** "Shh, let's listen to the story."
- C.** "Read the word truck for me."
- D.** "Yes, a big red dump truck! Can you say dump truck?"

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A third grader ~~who is the oldest of four siblings~~ reads a grade-level passage aloud quickly and accurately. When asked what happened, she cannot retell it or explain several key words. ~~She also loves recess soccer.~~ Using the Simple View of Reading, where is the breakdown?

Target word: locate the breakdown **Decides:** Decoding is strong; understanding is weak.

A	Adjacent category	The evidence shows one strong factor and one weak one.
B	Absolute language	She already reads quickly; speed does not fix weak language comprehension.
C	Inverted operation	Her decoding is strong; this names the wrong factor.
D	Correct	Accurate, fast decoding with poor understanding points to the language side.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

A first grader retells a read-aloud in rich detail and explains new words well, but reads short simple words very slowly and with many errors. Which instructional focus fits best?

Target word: choose the focus — opposite profile **Decides:** Strong language comprehension, weak decoding.

A	Absolute language	Decoding does not develop automatically from listening.
B	Correct	The weak factor is decoding.
C	Inverted operation	Targets the student's strength, not the weak factor.
D	Dropped element	Leaves out the explicit decoding instruction the student needs.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A kindergarten class has learned short a and the consonants m, s, t, p, and n. The teacher, ~~who recently moved from a middle school position~~, has a beautiful ~~award-winning~~ picture book the class adores. What should the children read on their own this week?

Target word: text for independent practice **Decides:** Beginners practice with text matching taught patterns.

A	Absolute language	Children can practice with decodables as soon as a few sounds are known.
B	Camouflage	Great for read-aloud, but its words are far beyond their decoding.
C	Correct	Decodable text lets them apply what they were taught.
D	Adjacent category	Pattern books invite memorizing and guessing, not decoding.

4. Answer C Concept 3

During small-group reading ~~in a bright classroom near the library~~, a first grader reads “horse” as “pony” in a decodable story that shows a picture of a pony. ~~The group meets every morning at 9:15.~~ What should the teacher prompt?

Target word: best prompt **Decides:** The child used the picture, not the letters.

A	Confusion set	A context cue from the three-cueing set; still guessing.
B	Dropped element	Drops the correction altogether.
C	Correct	Directs attention to the print, building decoding.
D	Inverted operation	Rewards guessing from the picture instead of reading.

5. Answer B Concept 4

A second-grade teacher is reading a picture book about a sea turtle that includes the words ocean, swim, reluctant, carapace, and fortunate. ~~The book was a gift from a local aquarium.~~ Which two words are the best targets for direct vocabulary teaching?

Target word: which words to teach **Decides:** Tier 2 words are high-utility across texts.

A	Absolute language	Direct-teaching time is limited; prioritize Tier 2.
B	Correct	Tier 2: useful across many texts and not likely known yet.
C	Adjacent category	Tier 1 everyday words most students already know.
D	Camouflage	Pulls toward the aquarium/sea theme; carapace is Tier 3 and ocean Tier 1.

6. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

A teacher labels photosynthesis a Tier 2 word because students will need it on a science test. What tier is it, and why?

Target word: classify the word — correct the reverse label **Decides:** Photosynthesis belongs to one field (science).

A	Correct	Domain-specific words are Tier 3.
B	Absolute language	All words have a tier; Tier 3 words are taught in context.
C	Inverted operation	Tier 1 is everyday conversational words; this is technical.
D	Adjacent category	Being tested does not make a word general-purpose.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A fourth-grade teacher finds a novel with a Lexile measure right in the grade band. ~~The novel has a glossy cover and a series of sequels.~~ However, it jumps back and forth in time and uses heavy satire. What should the teacher conclude?

Target word: judgment of fit **Decides:** Qualitative features can raise complexity beyond the number.

A	Camouflage	Series appeal does not decide complexity.
B	Correct	Complexity uses all three parts, not the number alone.
C	Absolute language	The number is one valid part of the three.
D	Dropped element	Drops the qualitative and reader-task parts.

8. Answer A Concept 5 • transfer

Two books have the same Lexile. One is a straightforward story; the other needs a lot of background knowledge about the Civil War. Which part of text complexity explains why the second is harder?

Target word: which part explains the difference **Decides:** Knowledge demands are a qualitative feature.

A	Correct	Background knowledge required is a qualitative dimension.
B	Confusion set	A quantitative input, already equal between the two.
C	Inverted operation	The quantitative measure is identical for both.
D	Adjacent category	The text itself differs; the difference sits in its qualitative features.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A class ~~that meets in a portable building~~ reads a short story in which a tortoise and a hare race, the slow tortoise wins, and the last line says, "Slow and steady wins the race." ~~The book has watercolor illustrations.~~ Which genre is this?

Target word: genre **Decides:** Animal characters plus a stated moral.

A	Adjacent category	Legends center on an exaggerated hero with some historical basis.
B	Dropped element	Ignores that talking animals and a moral mark traditional literature.
C	Confusion set	Myths explain nature or origins, often with gods.
D	Correct	Short tale with animal characters and an explicit moral.

10. Answer C Concept 6 · transfer

A teacher wants a traditional story that explains how something in nature came to be. Which genre should the teacher look for?

Target word: choose the genre from the purpose **Decides:** Explaining origins of nature is the hallmark of myth (and pourquoi tales).

A	Absolute language	Tall tales exaggerate a hero; not all traditional stories explain nature.
B	Confusion set	Fables teach a moral, not origins.
C	Correct	These explain natural phenomena or origins.
D	Adjacent category	Legends focus on a hero, not the origin of nature.

11. Answer A Concept 7

A teacher auditing a classroom library, ~~which was funded by a grant last year,~~ finds that the only books with Latino characters are about a holiday celebration and immigration hardship. ~~Shelves were recently repainted.~~ What is the best next step?

Target word: best next step **Decides:** Portrayals are narrow; add varied, authentic everyday stories.

A	Correct	Mirrors and windows need range and authentic portrayal.
B	Camouflage	The funding history does not decide what the library needs.
C	Dropped element	More of the same narrow portrayal misses variety.
D	Absolute language	Hard stories have value; the issue is that they are the only portrayal.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A preschool teacher reads a picture book to four-year-olds ~~while sitting in a rocking chair her grandmother gave her.~~ A child points and says, "Truck!" Which response follows dialogic reading?

Target word: best response **Decides:** Evaluate and expand the child's answer, then invite a repeat.

A	Dropped element	Evaluates but drops the expansion and repeat.
B	Inverted operation	Shuts down the talk dialogic reading is built on.
C	Adjacent category	A decoding demand, not oral-language building, for a four-year-old.
D	Correct	Evaluates, expands, and invites repetition (PEER).

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	8	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	The Simple View of Reading	Reading comprehension = decoding × language comprehension; if either is zero, comprehension fails, and literature builds the language side.	Thinking strong decoding alone guarantees comprehension.	A reader who decodes well but does not understand, or understands read-alouds but cannot decode.
2	Decodable text vs. read-aloud literature	Decodable texts let beginners practice the phonics patterns they have been taught; rich read-aloud literature, above their decoding level, builds vocabulary and comprehension.	Having beginners read complex trade books on their own, or limiting read-alouds to decodable books.	Who is reading: the child independently or the teacher aloud.
3	Prompting for word reading	When a child misreads a word, prompt them to look at the letters and sound it out; do not prompt guessing from pictures or context (three-cueing).	“Look at the picture — what would make sense?”	A child stuck on a word during reading.
4	Tier 2 vocabulary	Tier 1 words are everyday, Tier 2 are high-utility words across texts (e.g., reluctant, fortunate), Tier 3 are domain-specific; Tier 2 words from literature give the most payoff for direct teaching.	Spending direct instruction on rare technical words or words students already know.	Choosing which words from a book to teach.
5	Three-part text complexity	Text complexity weighs quantitative measures (like Lexile), qualitative features (meaning, structure, language, knowledge demands), and reader-and-task factors.	Using a readability number alone to decide a text is right.	A Lexile score that seems to settle the question.
6	Genres of traditional literature	Fables teach a stated moral with animal characters; folktales come from oral tradition of ordinary people; myths explain nature or origins with gods; legends exaggerate a real or once-believed hero.	Calling every old story a fairy tale or a myth.	A moral, an origin explanation, or a hero based on history.
7	Mirrors, windows, and sliding glass doors	A classroom library should let students see themselves (mirrors) and others (windows) through authentic, non-stereotyped portrayals across many texts.	Adding one book per group, or using only books about holidays or hardship.	A book-selection or library-audit decision.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Dialogic and interactive read-aloud	During read-alouds, prompt children to talk (complete, recall, open-ended, wh-, distancing questions), evaluate, expand their answer, and repeat; talk builds oral language.	Reading straight through with no talk so the story is not interrupted.	What the adult does during a shared reading.

Course scope (public description): Foundations of Literacy through Literature is an enriching course designed for educators and literacy enthusiasts, focusing on the exploration and utilization of literature to foster growth in the skills and concepts necessary for reading. This course delves into the role of varied and age-appropriate literary works in the science of reading to develop reading, writing, speaking, and listening abilities in learners. Students examine a broad range of genres to understand how different texts can be used to enhance vocabulary, comprehension, and critical thinking. This analysis allows the candidate to not only successfully integrate literature into meaningful instruction, but it is designed to cultivate a deep appreciation for reading itself. The curriculum emphasizes interactive and creative teaching strategies to engage learners effectively and integrate culture into their literacy instruction. The candidate is given real-world examples for how to create an inclusive environment that respects and celebrates different perspectives through quality text. By the end of the course, students are prepared with the knowledge and practical skills to use literature as a powerful tool in the development of comprehensive literacy skills.